THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

OFFICIAL COURSE WORKBOOK

COMMUNICATION MASTERY

8 Ways to Speak, Listen & Influence With Excellence

The quality of your communication determines the quality of your life.

COMMUNICATION SKILLS

COURSE WORKBOOK

ZEKI UBOR

Founder, The Becoming Institute

www.origin.com.ng

INTRODUCTION

Julian Treasure, the featured expert in this course, identifies 4 bad communication habits (gossip, judgment, negativity, and complaining) and 4 powerful foundations of effective speaking through his HAIL framework: Honesty, Authenticity, Integrity, and Love.

Communication is not just what you say. It is how you make people feel. It is the confidence you project, the clarity of your thinking, the depth of your listening, and the integrity of your follow-through. This workbook trains all four dimensions.

THE 8 WAYS — FRAMEWORK OVERVIEW

1. Speak With Clarity and Structure
Use the PREP framework: Point, Reason, Evidence, Point. Structure your thoughts before speaking.

2. Listen at Level 5 — Empathic Listening
Most people listen to reply. Listen to understand — including what is not being said.

3. Command Non-Verbal Presence
93% of communication impact is non-verbal. Your posture, eye contact, and tone speak before your words.

4. Speak Confidently in Public
Public speaking is a learnable skill. The secret is preparation, audience-focus, and consistent practice.

5. Write With Impact and Precision
Every email and message is a demonstration of your thinking. Apply the POWER writing method.

6. Navigate Difficult Conversations
The Crucial Conversations framework teaches you to speak honestly without triggering defensiveness.

7. Use Questions Strategically
The right question opens doors that statements slam shut. Master open, probing, and hypothetical questions.

8. Build Your Communication Habits Daily
Communication mastery is not an event. It is a daily practice with a 30-day feedback loop.

JULIAN TREASURE'S HAIL FRAMEWORK — THE FOUNDATION OF TRUST IN COMMUNICA

Julian Treasure (45M+ views TED Talk, featured in this course) identifies the foundation of powerful, trusted communication through HAIL:

H — Honesty: Speak the truth, even when it is uncomfortable. Dishonesty — even small — destroys credibility irreparably.
A — Authenticity: Be yourself. People can sense performance and inauthenticity within seconds.
I — Integrity: Do what you say you will do. Your commitments are your communication's highest test.
L — Love: Not sentimentality — but genuinely wishing good for the person you are communicating with. It changes your tone, your choice of words, and your listening quality.

He also identifies the 7 Deadly Sins of Speaking: gossip, judging, negativity, complaining, excuses, exaggeration, and dogmatism. Eliminating these is the fastest route to communication credibility.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Which of the 7 Deadly Sins is your most common communication habit? What will you replace it with?

Rate yourself on HAIL (1-10 each). Which dimension will you strengthen first, and how?

THE 5 LEVELS OF LISTENING — EMPATHIC MASTERY

Stephen Covey identified 5 levels of listening:

Level 1 — Ignoring: Not listening at all.
Level 2 — Pretending: Appearing to listen without absorbing.
Level 3 — Selective: Hearing only what confirms your existing view.
Level 4 — Attentive: Actively processing the words being spoken.
Level 5 — Empathic: Understanding the emotion and meaning beneath the words.

Most professional relationships operate at Level 3-4. Relationships built at Level 5 become the foundation of influence, trust, and deep collaboration.

The Listen-Mirror-Ask Method:
1. Listen fully without interrupting.
2. Mirror: "What I'm hearing you say is..."
3. Ask: "What does that mean for you?"

- In your next 5 conversations, commit to listening at Level 5.
- Remove all devices before an important conversation.
- After someone finishes speaking, pause for 3 seconds before responding.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Who in your life most deserves Level 5 listening from you? What is stopping you?

What happens in conversations when someone truly listens to you at Level 5? How can you give that more?

NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION — THE LANGUAGE BEFORE LANGUAGE

Albert Mehrabian's classic research demonstrated that in emotional communication:
- 7% of impact comes from words
- 38% comes from tone of voice
- 55% comes from body language

This means your body has already communicated your confidence, openness, and credibility before you say a single word.

The 5 Non-Verbal Signals That Build Authority:
1. Posture: Upright, open, grounded. Signals security.
2. Eye contact: Sustained (2-4 seconds), warm. Signals presence.
3. Gestures: Open palms, controlled movements. Signals honesty.
4. Vocal variety: Pace, pitch, pause. Monotone kills engagement.
5. Proximity: Appropriate physical presence. Signals confidence and connection.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Observe yourself in a mirror or recording. What does your non-verbal communication currently signal?

Which of the 5 non-verbal signals will you deliberately improve? What is your first practice step?

CRUCIAL CONVERSATIONS — SPEAKING TRUTH WITHOUT TRIGGERING DEFENSIVENES

Patterson, Grenny, McMillan & Switzler (Crucial Conversations) identify that when stakes are high and emotions run strong, most people choose between silence (withholding truth) or violence (attacking).

The master communicator builds a third path: speaking candidly while maintaining psychological safety.

The STATE Method for Crucial Conversations:
S — Share your facts (not interpretations)
T — Tell your story (the meaning you made of the facts)
A — Ask for the other's path (their perspective)
T — Talk tentatively ("It seems to me..." "I may be wrong...")
E — Encourage testing ("What do you see differently?")

The most powerful phrase in difficult conversations: "Help me understand your perspective."

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Write a crucial conversation you have been avoiding. Apply the STATE method — what would you say?

What is your current default pattern under communication pressure — silence or violence? What is your new response?

30-DAY TRANSFORMATION PRACTICE PLAN

Week 1 — Foundation (HAIL & Listening)

- Day 1-3: Eliminate one of the 7 Deadly Sins from your daily communication.
- Day 4-5: Practise Level 5 listening in every significant conversation.
- Day 6-7: Record yourself speaking for 2 minutes. Review for clarity and tone.

Week 2 — Body Language & Vocal Power

- Day 8-10: Practise open posture and direct eye contact in all conversations.
- Day 11-12: Vary your vocal pace and pitch deliberately in one meeting or call.
- Day 13-14: Apply the Listen-Mirror-Ask method in 3 conversations.

Week 3 — Public Speaking & Written Communication

- Day 15-17: Prepare and deliver a 3-minute talk to a trusted person using PREP.
- Day 18-19: Apply the POWER writing method to your top 5 emails this week.
- Day 20-21: Study Julian Treasure's TED Talk again. Identify 3 techniques you missed.

Week 4 — Difficult Conversations & Mastery

- Day 22-25: Have one crucial conversation you have been avoiding, using the STATE method.
- Day 26-28: Write your Personal Communication Manifesto — your communication values.
- Day 29-30: Teach someone else the HAIL framework. Teaching is the deepest learning.

MY TRANSFORMATION COMMITMENT

My single most important goal from this course:

Three specific actions I will take in the next 7 days:

How I will measure my progress:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

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Transforming Individuals. Building Leaders. Shaping Generations.

Founder: Zeki Ubor | www.origin.com.ng

This workbook accompanies the "8 Ways to Improve Communication" course on the Origin platform.

This workbook is your practical companion for transformational learning. Every framework, worksheet, and reflection exercise has been designed to move you from insight to action — from knowing to becoming.

The Becoming Institute believes that education is not a destination — it is a daily practice. Carry this workbook with you. Return to it. Complete the exercises. Discuss them with your accountability partner. Teach them to someone else.

This is not just a guide. This is your blueprint.

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